

CloudScale Global: SRE Incident Response & On-Call Playbook

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP-804) | Revision: 2026.2 | Security Classification: Internal

1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines the mandatory incident response lifecycle, on-call expectations, escalation paths, and Slack communication protocols for all engineering systems operating within CloudScale production infrastructure.

2. Incident Severity Classification Matrix

- **Sev-1 (Critical Outage):** Customer-facing service down, data corruption risk, or catastrophic revenue loss. Response SLA: **< 15 minutes**. War room mandatory. Slack cadence: Status update every 30 minutes in #incident-war-room.
- **Sev-2 (Major Degradation):** Core functionality severely impaired with no immediate workaround. Response SLA: **< 30 minutes**. Slack cadence: Status update every 60 minutes.
- **Sev-3 (Moderate Impact):** Non-critical feature failure with viable workaround available. Response SLA: **< 2 hours**. Resolution targeted within 2 business days.
- **Sev-4 (Minor Issue / Query):** Cosmetic glitch or low-priority bug. Response SLA: **Next business day**.

3. Incident Command Structure & Roles

- **Incident Commander (IC):** Owns the incident workflow, assigns tasks, coordinates communication, and shields responders from distractions.
- **Technical Lead (TL):** Drives root-cause investigation, log analysis, telemetry review, and executes rollbacks or hot-fixes.
- **Communications Lead (CL):** Crafts public status-page updates and executive summaries for leadership channels.

4. Slack Incident Channels & Escalation Protocol

- **War Room Creation:** For Sev-1 incidents, the IC must immediately spin up #incident-[ticket-id] and declare the war room.
- **Paging the On-Call Engineer:** Trigger the on-call responder with @oncall-sre in the incident channel. Alternatively, run the Slack shortcut /pager duty trigger sev-1 to page the appropriate on-call engineer directly.
- **Post-Mortem Requirement:** A blameless post-mortem must be drafted within 48 hours for all Sev-1 and Sev-2 incidents and indexed in the knowledge base.